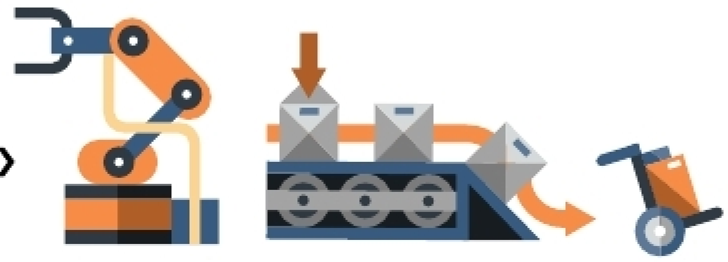

Industry Updates

India emerging as the world's second largest cellphone manufacturing hub

India is taking rapid strides in electronics production and has emerged as the world's second largest cellphone manufacturing hub, President Ram Nath Kovind said. While addressing a joint session of both houses of Parliament, the President said value of electronic goods manufactured in India has increased to ₹ 4.58 trillion in 2018-19 from ₹ 1.90 trillion in 2014-15.

He added that, in 2014, there were only two companies manufacturing mobiles in India, but today the country is the second largest mobile manufacturing hub in the world. He also said that the government is promoting the manufacture of cellphones, TVs and other electronic devices, and National Policy on Electronics has been formulated just for this.

The government has set a target of achieving a turnover of US$ 400 billion by 2025 for the Indian electronics industry.

For the mobile handset segment alone, under National Policy on Electronics 2019, the government has set a target of making one billion mobile handsets indigenously by 2025, valued at about thirteen trillion rupees.

The President also said that technology is playing a major role in bringing cities and villages closer. Already, more than 125,000 *gram panchayats* have been connected with high-speed broadband under BharatNet scheme. In 2014, there were 60,000 Common Service Centres in rural areas. These have increased to more than 365,000 now, and are providing employment to more than 1.2 million villagers. Through these centres, the government is delivering more than 45 services in rural areas.

EVs to become cheaper than ICE vehicles in three years

Electric vehicles (EVs) will become cheaper than internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles in three years as the price of their battery packs is expected to fall by almost 51 per cent, according to Amitabh Kant, chief executive officer, NITI Aayog. He was speaking at Mobility Talk Corporate Conclave during World Sustainable Development Summit (WSDS) 2020, TERI's annual flagship event, which was held recently in Delhi.

The price of EV battery packs is expected to fall to US$ 76 per kilowatt hour (or unit) in three years. At present, it is US$ 156 per unit. Kant said that given the size and scale of the growth expected, Indian industry must be the biggest driver of change to make the country a global EV manufacturing centre.

He added that there are two challenges that need to be addressed. The first is to focus on a new form of urbanisation, which is based on public transportation, and the second is to ensure India does not lose out as a global manufacturer.

Kant stressed on strengthening public transport. He said that it is essential that innovative and sustainable development is backed by embedding the cities with public transportation and not private transport. CNG-based transport should be used for travel within cities, and liquefied natural gas (LNG) should be used for inter-city travel. He also emphasised the need to focus on hydrogen fuel in the long run, for public transport.

India targets capacity of 450GW of renewable energy by 2030

India has set an ambitious target of installing a capacity of 450GW of renewable energy by 2030, President Ram Nath Kovind said. The Indian government aims to provide 1.7 million solar pumps to farmers under *Pradhan Mantri Kusum Yojana* to capitalise on this clean resource, reported *PTI*.

The country is already working towards achieving a capacity of 175GW of renewable energy by 2022, which includes 100GW of solar and 60GW of wind energy. Till December 2019, 86GW of renewable energy capacity had already been achieved. This included 34GW of solar and 38GW of wind energy. Subsequently, 36GW of clean energy generating installations have been initiated and capacity of around 35GW is in the bidding stage.

ON THE move

Arvind Krishna named IBM CEO

Indian-origin technology executive Arvind Krishna has been elected chief executive officer (CEO) of American IT giant IBM after a world-class succession process. He succeeds Virginia Rometty, who described him as the right CEO for the next era at IBM and well-positioned to lead the company into the cloud and cognitive era. Arvind Krishna had joined IBM in 1990. He has an undergraduate degree from Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, and a PhD in electrical engineering from University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign.